

Annual meeting on reporting on climate and energy under the adapted Governance Regulation

The annual project meeting brought together heads of climate change and energy units from relevant ministries and agencies across the Energy Community Contracting Parties that report under the adapted Governance Regulation, alongside representatives of the Energy Community Secretariat, DG ENEST, DG CLIMA, DG ENER, and the EEA. It provided a forum to review progress and challenges in reporting, align stakeholder expectations and priorities for project activities and agree on the workplan for the coming year.

MEETING SUMMARY – SESSION PER SESSION

TUESDAY 02.06.2026

The meeting was opened with welcoming remarks from the organisers, who highlighted the importance of reporting under the adapted Governance Regulation as a foundation for cooperation, transparency and evidence-based climate and energy policymaking across the EU and the Energy Community. The discussion also reflected on the evolving policy context and the role of reporting in supporting climate and energy objectives. Particular emphasis was placed on **the need to strengthen institutional capacity and establish sustainable national systems for climate and energy reporting** to ensure the long-term quality, consistency and reliability of reported data.

In addition, the European Commission through DG ENEST and DG CLIMA described how the project fits into the enlargement process which is accelerating considerably. This brings both an increased momentum, but also increased demands as an EU Member State must comply with the reporting requirements of the Governance Regulation. As highlighted by the Energy Community Secretariat, the importance of increasing the institutional capacity for reporting is a fundamental step to support reporting, which is still lagging for many Contracting Parties.

Stocktake of reporting progress and actions since last meeting

Daniel Giorev, Head of Unit, Climate Neutrality, Energy and Mobility, EEA

The EEA presented an overview of reporting progress under the adapted Governance Regulation. Performance improved steadily, with increased submissions and stronger engagement from Contracting Parties. However, significant variability persisted: established dataflows such as GHG inventories showed high completeness, while GHG projections and key indicators lagged. Performance also differed across countries, with no full compliance achieved, though targeted training had a positive impact on reporting outcomes.

The presentation also reviewed actions undertaken since the previous annual meeting, organised around four priority areas.

First, in institutional coordination, the previous annual meeting noted that reporting systems had been hindered by weak inter-ministerial coordination, as well as unclear roles and mandates for responsible institutions.

To address these challenges, several actions had been agreed and implemented. The EEA has shared good coordination practices through webinars and training sessions, aiming to strengthen governance structures and clarify responsibilities. Beyond this, the EEA initiated a study analysing coordination practices across Contracting Parties, with the objective of better understanding existing national systems for policies and measures and projections. The study will also identify areas for improvement.

Second, with regard to IT systems, challenges persisted due to misalignment between national reporting templates and the formats required in central systems. In response, the EEA had continued developing tools to facilitate data transfer between UNFCCC and Governance Regulation reporting frameworks, thereby reducing duplication and administrative burden. The EEA has also developed detailed factsheets clarifying similarities and differences between reporting obligations.

Third, in terms of technical capacity building, while Contracting Parties' capacities have been strengthened, gaps remain. The EEA has continued to offer webinars, in-person trainings, and technical exchanges, alongside the promotion of peer-learning opportunities. These activities responded directly to strong demand from Contracting Parties and contributed to improving reporting performance and confidence.

Finally, regarding strategic and political relevance, measures had been taken to increase the visibility and impact of reported data. The reported data from Contracting Parties have been integrated into Energy Community Secretariat assessments and EEA analytical outputs, while feedback mechanisms through quality control processes had been reinforced. This with the intention to demonstrate the value of reporting and supported the case for allocating additional resources to strengthen national reporting systems.

In conclusion, the presentation demonstrated that reporting performance had improved, supported by sustained capacity-building efforts. Nonetheless, important gaps persisted in more complex dataflows, underscoring the continued need for technical support, coordination, and resource allocation.

Learning from institutional capacity building: Examples from EU Member States and Contracting Parties

Cris-Tiina Pärn, Adviser, Estonian Environmental Research Centre

Sandra Lazić, Ministry of Environmental Protection of Serbia

Eva Jensen, Head of Climate Department and Circular Economy, EEA

Institutional capacity building is central to strengthening the reporting capacity of Contracting Parties. To illustrate different approaches, three speakers shared examples of how their organisations have developed this capacity. Participants were asked to listen through different thematic lenses and then discuss the main lessons with others who had the same focus. The section presents the key points that emerged from the discussions.

Institutional capacity and reporting quality improve over time

Participants identified external drivers, such as the introduction of the adapted Governance Regulation, as turning points for institutional capacity building. These drivers helped shift reporting from project-based approaches towards more permanent institutional arrangements. Lessons from the first reporting cycles also contribute to strengthening institutions: reporting itself is a learning process, and the first steps are often the most difficult.

Clear governance and institutional frameworks are critical enablers

Successful reporting systems depend on strong legislative and institutional arrangements that allow for multidisciplinary involvement of both policy and data experts. This is essential to bear in mind when setting up coordination mechanisms.

As well, it is important to create a back-up of support to understanding the reporting obligations so this is not only nested in one person, and to document the procedures. In this, both national and Energy Community level (through the EEA) networks can help.

Continuous capacity building and knowledge management are vital

Capacity building should be a continuous process, not limited to compliance cycles. It should be supported by clear documentation, effective digital reporting systems and access to trainers where national capacity is limited. Peer learning and exchange can also play an important role.

Sustainable reporting systems rely on gradual improvement and clear responsibilities

Participants also stressed the importance of documenting reporting procedures. Well-documented processes make it easier to share knowledge among counterparts and support continuity during staff transitions. Clearly defined roles and responsibilities are essential to this.

Data quality under the adapted Governance Regulation reporting

Per Wretlind, Climate Mitigation Monitoring Expert, EEA

Aneliya Nikolova, Climate Adaptation Expert, EEA

Claire Qoul, GHG Inventories and Review Expert, EEA

Oskar Gustafsson, Climate Mitigation and Energy Expert, EEA

The EEA presented an assessment of the quality of data reported under the adapted Governance Regulation. The stocktake was organised by reporting area, covering GHG inventories, mitigation, adaptation, energy and climate finance. The overarching insights are shared below:

- **Mitigation - Integrated Policies and Measures (PaMs):** Four submissions were received. While this represents limited reporting, several Contracting Parties indicated that work is ongoing. In terms of data quality, the main issues relate to consistency and completeness. Consistency issues were observed within PaMs, particularly regarding the alignment between implementation status, timeframes and projection scenarios. Although many of these issues are identified and addressed through manual quality

control, some inconsistencies remain. Completeness is also a challenge, with very limited quantitative information reported across submissions.

- **Mitigation - national systems:** Six submissions were received, all of which were complete. However, the reports show that national systems for policies and measures and projections have only recently been established or are still being developed. The EEA, in collaboration with the Energy Community Secretariat, has commissioned a report on these systems in the Contracting Parties. The report will describe their current status and provide guidance on how to improve or establish them, building on a similar report prepared for EU Member States. It is expected to be available in late 2026.
- **National Energy and Climate Progress Reports (NECPRs) - GHG emissions and removals; energy:** An overview of decarbonisation (Annex I), renewable energy (Annex II, Annex XVI), and energy efficiency (Annex IV and Annex XVII) reporting 2025. Five submissions were received for Annex I and seven for Annex II, Annex XVI, Annex IV, and Annex XVII. The submissions show positive signs of increasing renewable energy shares and overall provide a solid foundation to grasp the status amongst Contracting Parties, which can serve as a basis for more complete data submissions in future cycles. Completeness and interpretation of data to be filled in varied across submissions, making comparability challenging. Finally, increasing the addition of supporting documentation will also better contextualise data submitted, with most gaps having been resolved during the manual QA/QC cycle in 2025.
- **GHG Inventories:** Eight submissions were received, demonstrating a strong level of engagement from the Contracting Parties. However, the quality and completeness of the submissions varied. The initial quality-check process is designed to support improvements in inventory reporting, and a higher number of observations should not be interpreted as an indication of lower data quality. In contrast, only four approximated inventories were submitted in the previous reporting cycle, highlighting the need for continued efforts to improve reporting coverage in this area.
- **Adaptation:** The reporting provides a good overview of climate risks and how Contracting Parties incorporate climate adaptation considerations into their legal frameworks but offers limited information on implementation and monitoring of climate adaptation action, making it difficult to assess progress towards climate resilience across the Contracting Parties. Under the NECPR, more comprehensive reporting on adaptation goals would improve understanding of how NECPs and other climate policies support the effectiveness of mitigation measures under future climate conditions. More detailed reporting is also needed to better understand how Contracting Parties are planning adaptation measures across the dimensions of the Energy Union.
- **Climate finance:** Reporting is relatively straightforward where no carbon pricing mechanisms exist, but data on the use of such mechanisms needs to be strengthened in Contracting Parties where they do exist. Reporting on support to developing countries could also include contributions to international frameworks, such as the UNFCCC, as well as in-kind support.

Reporting under DG ENER's reporting platform

Peter Pozsgai, Lead of the CBAM Readiness Task Force, Governance Expert, Energy Community Secretariat

Guus van der Schouw, Team Lead for Governance, Energy Union and Simplification, DG ENER

The Energy Community Secretariat presented an overview of the quality of energy data reported through the Policy Reporting Platform (formerly ReportENER). They noted that the current reporting framework provides a good initial basis for energy reporting, although further improvements are needed to enhance data quality and consistency.

DG ENER explained how the European Commission uses the data reported by Member States. He noted that the digital Policy Reporting Platform has simplified reporting compared with previous approaches. While most reporting requirements are less complex than those managed through Reportnet, the reporting on energy subsidies remains particularly challenging.

He also highlighted that, despite the benefits of digitalisation, comparing data across Member States is not always straightforward. There is still scope to improve reporting templates and guidance to increase consistency and facilitate comparability.

Looking ahead, DG ENER is considering ways to strengthen the integration between NECPs and NECPRs as part of the ongoing revision of the Governance Regulation, with the aim of improving coherence and streamlining reporting.

Progress in NECP implementation and reporting

Anja Rosenberg, Technical Advisor, from the Energy Community Secretariat

Robyn Mitchell, Policy Officer, DG CLIMA

The session focused on progress in implementing NECPs and the role of reporting under the adapted Governance Regulation in tracking progress towards national climate and energy objectives.

The Energy Community Secretariat presented the findings of their assessment of adopted NECPs and 2025 NECPRs by the Contracting Parties. Seven Contracting Parties had adopted their NECPs and submitted NECPRs by the end of 2025. In their first NECPRs, Contracting Parties reported on a period, when NECPs were still under development. Thus, the reported figures could only reflect the starting point of NECP implementation. Some Contracting Parties already seem to be on good track to achieve their 2030 energy and climate targets, while others need to foster the implementation of policies and measures and structural reforms planned under their NECPs to align to the 2030 target trajectory. The first reporting cycle provided a valuable learning opportunity for Contracting Parties and established an initial basis for monitoring progress. The presentation highlighted that, although the first reporting cycle produced useful information, further improvements in the quality and completeness of reporting will be needed in future submissions.

DG CLIMA provided an overview of the European Commission's process for assessing Member States' progress towards their NECP targets within the Governance Regulation cycle. The assessment focuses on Member States' trajectories towards their 2030 climate targets, including those under the Effort Sharing Regulation (ESR) and the Land Use, Land-Use Change and Forestry (LULUCF) Regulation. The presentation highlighted that, based on current projections, a gap of around 2% remains to achieving the collective ESR targets, while the projected shortfall for the LULUCF sector is estimated at 45-60 MtCO₂eq. DG CLIMA explained how the Commission supports Member States through guidance, recommendations and the European Semester process. Particular emphasis was placed on the need for increased ambition where necessary, while also considering available flexibilities within the regulatory framework.

Estonia's NECP as a planning tool for achieving climate and energy targets

Merylin Möls, Head of Climate Policy Strategy, Ministry of Climate of Estonia

The Ministry of Climate of Estonia reflected on how the European Commission's assessment of Estonia's NECP implementation progress informs national policy development and decision-making. The intervention highlighted how EU-level feedback is used to strengthen planning, prioritisation and implementation at national level.

Estonia explained that the NECP framework helps bring together different institutions within a single planning structure, supporting a more coordinated approach to climate and energy policy. It also strengthens transparency and accountability in national reporting and policy delivery.

In practice, Estonia combines the European Commission's recommendations with its own cross-sectoral policy analysis in an annual review process. This process is used to assess progress, identify gaps, and adjust policies where necessary. The Commission's recommendations are valued as an external perspective that helps to review existing approaches and improve implementation.

WEDNESDAY 03.06.2026

Way forward

Per Wretling, Climate Mitigation Monitoring Expert, EEA

Aneliya Nikolova, Climate Adaptation Expert, EEA

Claire Qoul, GHG Inventories and Review Expert, EEA

The EEA opened the presentation by acknowledging the complexity of reporting requirements and their legal references. It noted that the EEA can provide support, but that this support needs to be targeted where it is most useful. Given the differing capacities of the Contracting Parties, reporters were encouraged to clearly identify their support needs during the world café discussion.

EEA presented the currently planned project activities for Q3/Q4 2026, and into Q1 of 2027:

- Preparation of 2027 dataflows and reporting guidelines
 - o Most dataflows open on 15 January and close on 15 March
- Webinars on 2027 reporting
 - o Thematic webinars per dataflow or reporting area (mitigation, adaptation, energy, climate finance, GHG inventories)
- Webinar on the requirements under the comprehensive review
- Regional thematic workshops
 - o GHG Inventory workshop in October to prepare for the 15 January submission deadline
 - o Mitigation/Energy/Adaptation workshop(s) in January (to prepare for the 15 March deadline)
- National trainings – upon request
- In addition to the regional workshops, we are discussing national workshops with several CPs.
- Reports:
 - o Report on ‘National Systems for PaMs and Projections’: Overview of national systems for PaMs and Projection across Contracting Parties, with a focus on identifying gaps, challenges and opportunities for closing the gaps.
 - Interviews will take place over the summer.
 - o Report on the state of adaptation across Contracting Parties
 - Based on data reported in the 2025 reporting cycle
 - Only countries that reported will be covered in the assessment
- Publication of reported data:
 - o Integration of reported data into EEA's datahub and visualisations of data on EEA's Climate-ADAPT and Climate and Energy Portal
 - o Completion of IT tools to transfer data between Reportnet and UNFCCC reporting tools
- Development of ‘Working Group’-like structures
 - o To enable technical exchange and facilitate peer learning
- To build on existing structures (e.g. the Teams space) and taking the ‘lean teams’ into account and to enable Contracting Parties to raise thematic, technical, or practical questions
- COP 31 Side-event:
 - o The aim of the event is to showcase the Contracting Parties as ‘Transparency frontrunners’ resulting from the increased reporting under the adapted Governance Regulation

EEA also presented on the 2027 Comprehensive review of the GHG inventory.

- 2027 comprehensive review of GHG inventories: scope (progress to targets), timeline, EMRT platform

- Purpose: to monitor Contracting parties' GHG reductions or limitation targets set out in Contracting Parties' legislation; comparing numbers to targets
- Timeline – deadline / timeline for comprehensive review for Contracting Parties not yet established. However, regardless of whether the timeline follows the current timeline implemented for Member States, this is a fast-paced process. It is expected that Contracting Parties will react quickly to questions received from the reviewers. It is important to prioritise this process and to ensure there is sufficient capacity to be fully engaged in the process.
- EMRT – overview of platform used to carry out initial checks. Coordinators are nominated and will be the primary point of contact, collects input, has greater access, and is the final reply considered. Experts have more limited access
- A draft review report is provided by the EEA, to which comments can be provided by Contracting Parties, before finalisation of the final review report
- The EEA highlighted the importance of sharing information by coordinators to all experts / institutions involved

World café on improving data quality and timely reporting

All participants

The EEA facilitated a world café to identify concrete actions to improve data quality and ensure more timely submission of reported information. Four groups were formed, and their outcomes are presented below.

Workplan review

Participants reviewed the indicative workplan for the coming implementation period.

The period from October 2026 to March 2027 is expected to be particularly intensive, with a high concentration of reporting-related activities, capacity-building events and support requests. Given the expected workload, early planning and scheduling of individual support activities will be essential to ensure effective delivery and participation.

- Contracting Parties are encouraged to provide additional comments and suggestions on the workplan by email following the meeting, complementing the discussions held during the event.
- The feedback will help ensure that planned activities reflect national priorities, reporting needs and available capacities.

The EEA and the Energy Community Secretariat will use the inputs received to prepare a detailed activity plan for the second half of 2026 and the first half of 2027. The plan will include indicative dates, formats and locations for training and capacity-building activities.

Early agreement on the activity schedule will help secure participation from relevant institutions, improve coordination among support providers and facilitate more effective resource planning.

During the breakout discussions, the following inputs were gathered from participants:

Effective activities:

- The Training on inventories held in Vienna
- Both thematic and national trainings are considered effective, depending on scope
- Suggestion to use doodle to gather reporter availability before planning thematic workshops (e.g. for the effective coordination of a workshop on inventories, a doodle can be sent out to inventories reporters to ensure maximum participation).

Preferred dates and potential conflicts or dates to work around:

- Serbia, Moldova: October/November is the most suitable time to allow sufficient time for data collection
- Ukraine: November/December can be challenging due to COP
- Albania: September/October and January/February are most suitable for training

Recommendations to workplan:

Moldova: will revise reporter list and additional needs, particularly with an interest in ensuring that capacity stays within the institutions (i.e. limiting reporting tasks to external consultants to ensure that knowledge stays in house).

Ukraine: recommendation to organise a training focusing on the identified gaps in the 2025 reporting and share best practices from Member States to help bridge the gap.

Serbia, Moldova, Albania: recommendation to hold the training on Projections before the end of the year.

Serbia: request for training on inventories and ETF reporting tool/CRT, including import/export.

Kosovo: request for additional training for new reporters.

Ukraine, Moldova: preferred time for training on Adaptation in January.

Note: Access to Bosnia and Herzegovina from Kosovo requires visas, so other locations for regional trainings are preferred.

Interinstitutional coordination

How is coordination currently working, and how can it be improved?

Bosnia and Herzegovina highlighted the importance of identifying relevant institutions and gathering expertise, stating that ministries across sectors should be better coordinated across national and regional level. Alignment and cooperation need to be improved, along with tailored support at regional level.

Albania shared that the Ministry of Energy and the Ministry of Environment collect data from agencies, however regular coordination is limited and data are sometimes missing. A suggestion to establish a new working group collecting data from various institutions was put

forward, with clear responsibilities and what should be reported and who the responsible party is.

Montenegro noted that coordination could be strengthened, as responsibility for reporting across different dataflows is shared among several actors, making coordination more challenging.

Ukraine stated that there is one ministry covering economy, environment and agriculture, and that there is a separate Ministry of Energy. Ukraine's green transition office consists of 15 people, which is responsible for reporting on NECP. There is an intra-ministerial working group consisting of deputy officers (e.g. for energy and infrastructure) meeting every three months to discuss progress, which is complemented by a monitoring system.

Overall, the issue of having a high turnover rate was raised, suggesting a stronger need for solid handover material and transitional periods to ensure a smooth transition for the actors responsible for reporting on their respective dataflows.

Data availability and quality

Regarding data availability and quality, participants noted that the necessary data often already exist within the Contracting Parties. The main challenge is ensuring that relevant stakeholders provide the data on time. Participants highlighted the value of training sessions as a way to bring stakeholders together. In-person national trainings, in particular, can help convene relevant institutions and communicate the importance of reporting across national stakeholders. Participants also stressed the need to give co-organisers space to explain the relevance of the exercise to their own stakeholders.

A second point concerned the organisation of the NECP process as a whole. Participants referred to the forthcoming report on national systems, which is expected to provide guidance on policies and measures and projections. This report could also serve as a starting point for improving reporting in other areas.

A third point focused on the need to engage higher-level stakeholders to secure resources for reporting. Participants called on the Energy Community Secretariat and the EEA to engage with senior institutional representatives and underline the importance of well-functioning reporting systems.

Timeliness and preparation

Regarding timeliness and report preparation, participants identified several challenges within the Contracting Parties, including limited capacity and insufficient knowledge of reporting obligations. Capacity should be strengthened in-house by increasing human resources rather than relying on project-based support. Participants also stressed the importance of retaining institutional knowledge, creating national ownership and responsibility for timely reporting, and assigning clear responsibilities across dataflows. Memoranda of understanding could support this process.

Participants also reiterated the data availability issues described above.

Sharing good practices and experiences among Contracting Parties could help improve reporting.

Reflections on the support needs identified

Tomasz Karpinski, European Green Deal Expert on GHG Inventories and MRV, Energy Community Secretariat

Challenges:

- Lack of **capacity** on institutional and expert level (incl. legal), making it difficult to establish responsibility and collaboration at national level
- **Excessive workload**: various obligations at national level, including UNFCCC, adapted Governance Regulation and other obligations under the Energy Community, EU accession
- **Political / decision-making level**: limited financial resources and low priority of climate issues
- The main blocker is practical implementation, include the source of the data and the stakeholder responsible for providing this data, responsibility of approving data etc.

Support:

- The EEA and the Energy Community Secretariat provide technical and capacity building support
- **Next level**: grasping overarching needs to support with more advanced data submission, incl. through high level political awareness, Governance Regulation coordination groups, Annual Implementation Report, and 2027 Comprehensive review of GHG inventories
- Discussion and notes from World Café to contribute to these next steps

Conclusions and wrap-up

Daniel Giorev, Head of Climate Neutrality, Energy, and Mobility Unit, EEA

The wrap-up highlighted three main takeaways from the meeting:

First, the period leading up to the full reporting cycle in 2027 presents both an opportunity and a challenge. Making use of this window will be crucial, in particular to strengthen national coordination and strategic preparation in the coming months. Participants were encouraged to raise specific comments and issues.

Second, emphasis was placed on governance and the importance of further strengthening national reporting systems. The need for more systemic and structured arrangements was underlined, including clear allocation of responsibilities. This would also help ensure institutional continuity and resilience beyond staff turnover and the end of individual projects. It was noted that existing reporting outputs, such as the report on national systems, can help identify and address remaining gaps.

Third, it was noted that Contracting Parties and reporters can draw on a range of support sources. Better identification of existing support needs will enable the EEA and the Energy Community Secretariat to tailor assistance more effectively. Contracting Parties were invited to provide a prioritised list of needs.